

Performance Improvement Plan

Confidential personnel document · for the employee and manager named below

Employee	Sohum Joshi — Software Engineer I (Intern)
Manager	[Manager name]
Date issued	22 June 2026
Review period	30 days — check-ins at day 10 and day 20
Classification	Confidential — internal; shared with employee and manager only

1. Purpose

This plan documents a specific area for improvement in deployment practice and sets out clear, supportive expectations going forward. It is prompted by a single, first-time incident. Its purpose is to help Sohum grow into safe, independent deployment work. It is not a mark against his record and not a final warning; on completion it closes with no lasting effect on his standing.

2. Background

On 21 June 2026, changes to the production deployment path — the new blue/green release flow — were committed late in the day and shipped without going through code review or staging verification. Sohum authored those commits. When the release ran, it retired the live web server before its replacement was confirmed healthy, which contributed to an extended outage of RMHStudios.com.

In fairness, and for accuracy: the outage was not the result of these commits alone. A production deployment that a single junior engineer can ship last-minute, unreviewed and untested, also reflects gaps in our review and release controls. Those gaps are being addressed separately and are not Sohum's responsibility. This plan is limited to the practices that were within his control.

3. Areas to improve

- **Change timing.** Production changes should not be committed last-minute; allow time for review ahead of any release window.
- **Mandatory review.** No change to the deployment path or other production-critical code should ship without a second engineer's review and approval.
- **Staging verification.** Deployment changes — especially anything that stops or replaces running services — must be tested in staging before production.
- **Escalation.** When a deploy behaves unexpectedly, stop and raise it immediately rather than pushing further changes.

4. Expectations and success criteria (next 30 days)

- All commits to production-critical paths are opened as reviewed pull requests with at least one approval before merge — target 100%.



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- No direct or last-minute pushes to production deployment code.
 - Any deployment-affecting change is demonstrated in staging first, with a short note on what was verified.
 - Questions and anomalies are raised early; asking for help is treated as a positive, not a shortfall.

5. Support we will provide

- A named mentor / reviewer paired with Sohum for all deployment-related work during the review period.
- A walkthrough of the release process, the staging environment, and the rollback procedure.
- Day-10 and day-20 check-ins to review progress and clear blockers.

6. Outcome

This is a first, recoverable situation. We expect Sohum to meet these expectations comfortably, and on doing so this plan closes with no lasting effect on his standing. The goal is simply a more confident engineer with sound deployment instincts.

Acknowledgement

Signing below confirms this plan has been read and discussed. It records receipt and a shared understanding of the expectations; it is not an admission of fault.

Employee

Manager

Sohum Joshi · Date

[Manager name] · Date